

STAGE TWO • PROFESSIONAL IDENTITY & PERSONAL BRAND

FIRSTS

ICEBREAKERS / OPENERS

Short, stage-themed warm-ups tied to what each session actually covers

A Citrus Edition Facilitator Resource • Companion to the FIRSTS Manual

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FIRSTS • Icebreakers / Openers

Stage Two • Professional Identity & Personal Brand

PURPOSE

Stage Two runs across six sections — Personal Professional Identity, Personal Brand Foundations, Digital Presence & Online Identity, Professional Communication, Professional Visibility, and Professional Materials — each substantial enough to run as its own session. Each gets one icebreaker below, built directly from that section's actual content rather than a generic warm-up.

Every one of these does real, if lighthearted, diagnostic work: surfacing a forgettable introduction, a self-perception gap, an unmanaged digital footprint, an interruption habit, weak content instincts, or a resume that describes duties instead of impact — all before the session's formal teaching begins, so the FIRSTS that follow land as solutions to something participants just noticed about themselves.

Each includes the instructions to read to the group, a time estimate, and a short note on why it's specifically the right opener for what comes next.

Six Openers, One Per Session

SESSION 1

The 60-Second Swap

TIME: 10 min

1. In pairs, each person has 60 seconds to introduce themselves exactly as they would to a stranger at a professional networking event — no notes, no rehearsal.
2. Partner gives one piece of feedback: what's the first concrete thing they remember afterward?
3. Swap roles, then discuss as a full group: how many people's “memorable thing” was a job title versus something more specific and human?

WHY THIS WORKS

This surfaces, before any formal teaching, that most people's default introduction is forgettable — exactly the gap FIRST 01 (Professional Introduction) and FIRST 02 (Elevator Pitch) are about to address.

SESSION 2

Guess the Brand

TIME: 8 min

1. Ask each participant to silently think of one word they'd want a colleague to use to describe them professionally.
2. Collect all the words anonymously (shared doc, sticky notes, or a chat poll) and display them together.
3. As a group, guess which word belongs to whom based only on how people have interacted so far in the program. Reveal and discuss: how close were the guesses?

WHY THIS WORKS

This is a light, low-stakes preview of the entire concept of personal brand — the gap between the word you'd choose for yourself and the impression you're actually giving off, which is exactly what Section 2 investigates.

SESSION 3

Google Yourself, Out Loud

TIME: 10 min

1. Ask participants to privately search their own name right now and note the first three results.
2. In pairs, share just one thing: was the first result something you'd want a hiring manager to see, or something you'd rather they didn't?
3. Quick full-group show of hands: who was surprised by what came up?

WHY THIS WORKS

A genuinely eye-opening, low-effort warm-up that makes the Digital Footprint Audit (FIRST 16) feel immediately relevant rather than abstract.

SESSION 4

Interrupt Bingo

TIME: 8 min

1. In small groups, have a genuinely unstructured 3-minute conversation about weekend plans, favorite shows, anything casual.
2. Assign one silent observer per group whose only job is tallying interruptions and talk-time imbalance.
3. Observer reports back: was airtime roughly equal? Did anyone finish others' sentences?

WHY THIS WORKS

This makes the specific communication habits covered in this session — listening, meeting presence, question-asking — observable and concrete before any formal teaching happens.

SESSION 5

Would You Share This?

TIME: 8 min

1. Show the group 3–4 sample LinkedIn post openers (facilitator-prepared: one generic humblebrag, one genuinely specific insight, one overly promotional, one authentic story).
2. Quick group vote: which one would you actually stop scrolling to read?
3. Brief discussion: what made the winning one different?

WHY THIS WORKS

Primes the group to think critically about content quality before they're asked to create their own posts and articles later in this session.

SESSION 6

Two-Minute Resume Roast (Kindly)

TIME: 10 min

1. Ask each participant to silently reread their own current resume's first bullet point under their most recent role.
2. In pairs, read that single bullet point aloud to a partner — nothing else.
3. Partner gives one honest reaction: does it sound like an accomplishment, or a job description?

WHY THIS WORKS

A fast, low-stakes way to surface the single most common resume weakness (describing duties instead of impact) right before the group tackles FIRST 35 (Resume That Stands Out) in depth.